



CES Eye Candy

If you missed CES launches this past month, skim through our slideshow online:
<http://digit.in/ceseyec>



JBL's Mountain

The SMART group launches JBL's Everest DD66000 audio system. Tagged at Rs. 99 lakh - 1 crore, audiophiles rejoice

CES 2014 hands out a reality check

Virtual reality, augmented reality and gaming unveil their next gen at CES 2014

Oculus Rift makes a breakthrough with New Motion Tracking

Virtual Reality has captured the attention of developers, consumers and corporates for decades. This year we saw Oculus Rift unveiling the latest prototype of their upcoming virtual reality headset code-named 'Crystal Cove'.

This latest prototype of the upcoming VR headset has made significant improvements to latency and blurring, with the addition of new positional tracking which was made possible with the addition of a new external camera to the Rift.

Compared to what we saw in previous iterations, the Rift was only able to track a player's head, eventually restricting movement to basic head movement. However, now Rift has positional tracking capabilities, thanks to an array of sensors mounted along the edges of the unit, monitored by an external camera. So, it's no longer just your head that controls movement, now you can move around and the virtual environment also moves in sync.

The Rift has a broad range of applications even beyond gaming. The company has sold developer kits to companies in various industries, from auto manufacturers to movie businesses. NASA has also used this technology to create virtual tours of Mars and the International Space Station.



The Oculus Rift

Oculus VP Nate Mitchell sums it up as a "new disruptive medium that can revolutionize the way we do a lot more than just games." Forbes is already calling it the Oculus

"The PC platform is successful because we all benefit from each other's accomplishments. "Today we're taking the next step. All of these partner developers are here and are interested in talking to you about your PC moving into the living room,"
 – Gabe Newell, Valve.

Rift effect as companies are trying to capitalise on this technological breakthrough.

However, the biggest challenge here will be making the Rift accessible to consumers. The company has not mentioned anything about the release date, apart from Mitchell saying that 2014 is going to be a big year for Virtual Reality. Oculus has made a mark this year at CES bagging the award for the best of CES award for 2014.

Valve unveils 13 Steam Machines

It was quite strange of Valve to visit this year's annual Con-

sumer Electronics Show, However this year marks Valve's attempts to send gamers into the world of Steam Machines and SteamOS.

Valve's Gabe Newell took centre stage at Valve's event and made them official, revealing specs for their gaming rigs including the likes of Alienware, CyberPower, Gigabyte, iBuyPower and more. In all, there are 13 machines in total, within a price bracket that varies from \$500 to \$6000 a piece. Each machine has the basic specs,

information on what is under the machine's hood. We can see a basic trademarked black box, showing off Alienware and Steam logos illuminating along with a pair of front facing USB ports. Not much has been revealed as to what's inside, but the fact that Alienware has traditionally been a super-powered machine, its safe to say it will come super-loaded along with a lot of multiple options.

Alternate (\$1339)

Alternate looks like a simple cubical box, but does pack a punch. Alternate's Steam Machine features an Intel Core i5 4570, an Nvidia GTX 760 GPU coupled with 16GB of RAM along with 1TB, via a hybrid solid state drive.

CyberPower PC (Price: TBA)

Cyber Power's Steam rig might remind you of the first generation of XBOX consoles. It packs a 3.9Ghz A6 CPU from AMD, a 2GB Radeon R9 270 GPU bundled with 8GB of RAM along with 500 GB of internal storage. For those of you who are not into AMD peripherals,

and even the cheapest offering could take on the likes of PS4 and XBOX One. Here's a run-down of unveilings at Valve's press conference:

Alienware (Price: TBA)

Dell revealed their Steam machine at Valve's event however did not let out a lot of



Alienware Steam machine